

The First Real Deadline: The Decision

第一个真实期限：决定

Theme: 求职、职场与职业发展 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6,127

English Story

The decision was taken around a **table** in the **studio**, with the **minister**, the **chairman**, and the **secretary** of the **embassy** all present. The **official** from the **registrar's** office attended by phone. "We must decide today," the **minister** said. "The **obligation** is not **temporary**." There were six of them around the **table**, and one empty chair for the **volunteer** who had resigned.

The general **case** was simple. The **service** would receive a **contribution**, a **negotiation**, and a **fee**; in exchange the team would carry the **debt**, the **penalty**, and the **marketing**. "That is not a partnership," Maya said. "That is a **job** with a nicer name." However, the company had been like this for a month, and the team had to say something.

The **expenditure** on paper alone was larger than the **donation**. A **player** from the football club, a **barber**, a **cashier**, and a **secretary** from the **personnel** office came to offer their **labor** for nothing; a **slave** in the old **architecture** of the **headquarters** building had once done the same for less. "A **vocation** is not a **penalty**," the **chairman** said. "Say what you want and we will write it."

The **resignation** of the **registrar** had made the **negotiation** harder. The **bonus**, the **retirement** plan, the **appliance** allowance, and the **supermarket** coupon were all **temporary**; the **work** was not. "I like the **sunrise** better than the **sunset**," Lin said. "I will take the smaller one." It was likely that the **chairman** would be angry; it was certain that the team would have to receive the answer together.

In the end they said no to the permanent post and yes to the **undertaking**. The **headquarters** wanted a **retirement** and got a **resignation**; the **embassy** wanted a **donation** and got a **homework** club instead. "There is a **commerce** in this that is not about money," Maya wrote, "and there is a **service** in it that is not about **service**." What would happen to the **studio** was a matter of some interest; so was the question of whether a small **undertaking** could **thrive** without a salary. It could, she said, if they were willing to **work** at **sunrise**.

中文翻译

决定是在工作室的一张桌边做出的，部长、主席和大使馆的秘书都在场。登记处的那位官员通过电话参加。“我们今天必须决定，”部长说，“这项义务不是临时的。”桌边有六个人，还有一把空椅子，属于那位辞职的志愿者。

一般的情形很简单。服务部门会收到一笔捐款、一次谈判和一笔费用；作为交换，团队要承担债务、罚金和营销。“这不是合伙关系，”曼雅说，“这是一份名字更好听的雇佣。”然而，公司这样已经一个月了，团队必须表态。

光纸张上的开支就大过那笔捐赠。足球俱乐部的一位球员、一位理发师、一位出纳员，以及人事办公室的一位秘书都来无偿提供劳动；总部大楼旧建筑风格里的一个奴隶，当年为更少的东西做过同样的事。“天职不是刑罚，”主席说，“说出你想要什么，我们就写下来。”

登记官的辞职让谈判变得更难了。奖金、退休计划、电器补贴和超市优惠券都是暂时的；而工作不是。“比起日落，我更喜欢日出，”林伟说，“我要那个小的。”主席很可能会发怒；而团队一定会一起收到这个答复。

最后他们对那个固定职位说了不，而对那项事业说了是。总部想要一个退休，得到的是一份辞呈；大使馆想要一笔捐赠，得到的却是一个家庭作业俱乐部。“这里面有一种与钱无关的商业，”曼雅写道，“也有一种与服务无关的服务。”工作室会怎样，是一件颇有意思的事；而一个小小的事业能否在没有薪水的情况下兴旺，也同样有意思。她说，能的——只要他们愿意在日出时就开始工作。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
work wɜ:k POS: n	n. 工作, 劳动, 职业, 行为, 功, 作品, 成果, 产品, 工程; vi. 工作, 劳动, 做, 运转, 起作用, 被加工; vt. ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. activity directed toward making or doing something; n. a product produced or accomplished through the effort...
case keɪs POS: n	n. 情形, 情况, 箱, 容器, 事实, 病例, 案例, 框子; vt. 装箱, 包盖 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an occurrence of something; n. the actual state of things; n. a portable container for carrying several objects...
service ˈse:vɪs POS: n	n. 服务, 贡献, 雇佣, 公职, 服役, 功劳, 仪式, 送达, 行政部门; vt. 保养, 维修; a. 武装部队的, 服务性的, 仆人的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. work done by one person or group that benefits another; n. an act of help or assistance; n. the act of public...
job dʒɒb POS: n	n. 工作, 零活, 职业, 事情; vi. 做零工, 打杂, 做股票经纪, 假公济私; vt. 代客买卖, 批发, 承包, 欺骗; [计] 作业 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a specific piece of work required to be done as a duty or for a specific fee; n. a workplace; as in the expression...
minister ˈmɪnɪstə POS: n	n. 部长, 牧师, 公使; vi. 服侍, 救助, 主持宗教仪式 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person appointed to a high office in the government; n. a diplomat representing one government to another...
table ˈteɪbl POS: n	n. 桌子, 餐桌, 工作台, 铭文, 表格, 表, 高原, 平地层; vt. 搁置, 嵌合, 制表, 把...列入议事日程; [计] 表格, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a set of data arranged in rows and columns; n. a piece of furniture having a smooth flat top that is usually...
player ˈpleɪə POS: n	n. 竞赛者, 上场队员, 游戏者, 演员; [经] 交易者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who participates in or is skilled at some game; n. a person who pursues a number of different social...
official əˈfɪʃl POS: n	n. 官员, 公务员, 职员; a. 公事的, 官方的, 正式的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a worker who holds or is invested with an office; n. someone who administers the rules of a game or sport; a...
secretary ˈsekrətəri POS: n	n. 秘书, 书记, 大臣; [经] 秘书 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who is head of an administrative department of government; n. an assistant who handles correspondence...
chairman ˈtʃeəməŋ POS: n	n. 主席, 会长; [经] 主席 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the officer who presides at the meetings of an organization; v. act or preside as chair, as of an academic degree...
attend əˈtend POS: vt	vt. 参加, 照料, 伴随; vi. 专心于, 照顾, 服侍, 出席 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be present at (meetings, church services, university), etc.; v. take charge of or deal with; v. to accompany...
labor ˈleɪbə POS: n	n. 劳动, 努力, 工作, 劳工, 分娩; vi. 劳动, 努力, 苦干; vt. 详细分析, 使厌烦 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a social class comprising those who do manual labor or work for wages; n. productive work (especially physical)...
studio ˈstju:diəu POS: n	n. 工作室, 画室, 演播室, 电影制片厂 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. workplace for the teaching or practice of an art; n. workplace consisting of a room or building where movies...
contribution ˌkɒntrɪˈbjʊ:ʃən POS: n	n. 捐助, 捐助之物, 贡献; [经] 贡献, 捐款, 补助品 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the part played by a person in bringing about a result; n. a voluntary gift (as of money or service or idea)...
debt det POS: n	n. 债务, 罪过; [经] 借款, 欠款, 债务 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of owing something (especially money); n. money or goods or services owed by one person to another...
fee fi: POS: n	n. 费用, 小费, 封地, 所有权; vt. 付费给 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a fixed charge for a privilege or for professional services; n. an interest in land capable of being inherited...
expenditure ɪkˈspendɪtʃə POS: n	n. 开支, 费用, 用光, 消费额; [经] 支出, 费用, 消费 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. money paid out; an amount spent; n. the act of spending money for goods or services; n. the act of consuming something...
marketing ˈmɑ:kitɪŋ POS: n	n. 行销, 买卖; [经] 推销, 在市场买卖, 销售 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the commercial processes involved in promoting and selling and distributing a product or service; n. shopping...
negotiation niˌɡəʊʃiˈeɪʃən POS: n	n. 谈判, 磋商, 交涉; [经] 谈判, 协商 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a discussion intended to produce an agreement; n. the activity or business of negotiating an agreement; common...

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obligation 'ɒbli'geɪʃən POS: n	n. 义务, 责任, 约束, 契约, 恩惠, 债务; [经] 待付款, 债务, 义务 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being obligated to do or pay something; n. a personal relation in which one is indebted for a...
volunteer 'vɒləntiə POS: n	n. 志愿者; a. 志愿的; v. 自愿 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (military) a person who freely enlists for service; n. a person who performs voluntary work; v. tell volunta...
penalty 'penəlti POS: n	n. 处罚, 刑罚, 罚款, 罚球, 报应, 不利结果, 妨碍; [经] 罚金(款), 违约金 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a payment required for not fulfilling a contract; n. the disadvantage or painful consequences of an action...
temporary 'tempərəri POS: a	a. 暂时的, 临时的; n. 临时工, 临时雇员; [计] 临时 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a worker (especially in an office) hired on a temporary basis; a not permanent; not lasting; s lacking contin...
personnel 'pɜ:sə'nel POS: n	n. 人员, 人事部门, 人事科(处); [经] 人事, 全体人员, 职工 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a group of people willing to obey orders; n the department responsible for hiring and training and placing emp...
retirement ri'taiəmənt POS: n	n. 退休, 隐居, 撤退; [经] 退休, 退股, (固定资产)报废 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being retired from one's business or occupation; n. withdrawal from your position or occupatio...
architecture 'ɑ:kitektʃə POS: n	n. 建筑学, 建筑式样; [计] 体系结构 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an architectural product or work; n. the discipline dealing with the principles of design and construction...
slave sleiv POS: n	n. 奴隶, 从动装置, 卑鄙的人; vi. 拼命工作; [计] 从设备 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who is owned by someone; n. someone who works as hard as a slave; n. someone entirely dominated by...
headquarters hed'kwɔ:təz POS: n	n. 总部, 司令部, 总部人员; [经] 本部, 总部, 总署 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (usually plural) the office that serves as the administrative center of an enterprise; n. the military inst...
resignation 'rezɪg'neɪʃən POS: n	n. 辞职, 辞呈, 听从; [经] 辞职 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. acceptance of despair; n. the act of giving up (a claim or office or possession etc.); n. a formal document...
serving 'sɜ:vɪŋ POS: n	n. 服务, 招待, 上菜, 一份食物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n an individual quantity of food or drink taken as part of a meal; n the act of delivering a writ or summons u...
bonus 'bəʊnəs POS: n	n. 奖金, 红利; [经] 奖金, 红利, 额外补贴 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. anything that tends to arouse; n. an additional payment (or other remuneration) to employees as a means of...
supermarket 'sju:pəmə:kit POS: n	n. 超级市场; [经] 超级市场, 自助售货商店 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a large self-service grocery store selling groceries and dairy products and household goods
commerce 'kɒmə:s POS: n	n. 商业, 商务, 贸易; [经] 商业, 贸易, 商务 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. transactions (sales and purchases) having the objective of supplying commodities (goods and services); n. s...
undertaking 'ʌndə'teɪkɪŋ POS: n	n. 事业, 企业, 保证; [经] 企业, 事业, 承担 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any piece of work that is undertaken or attempted; n. the trade of a funeral director
donation dəʊ'neɪʃən POS: n	n. 捐赠物, 捐款, 捐赠; [经] 赠品, 捐款, 捐赠 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a voluntary gift (as of money or service or ideas) made to some worthwhile cause; n act of giving in common...
embassy 'embəsi POS: n	n. 大使馆, 大使馆全体人员; [经] 大使馆 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a diplomatic building where ambassadors live or work; n. an ambassador and his entourage collectively
thrive θraiv POS: vi	vi. 繁荣, 兴旺, 茁壮成长; [经] 兴旺, 繁荣, 旺盛 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make steady progress; be at the high point in one's career or reach a high point in historical significanc...
homework 'həʊmwɜ:k POS: n	n. 家庭作业, 家里做的工作; [经] 家庭作业 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. preparatory school work done outside school (especially at home)
sunset 'sʌnset POS: n	n. 日落, 晚年 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the time in the evening at which the sun begins to fall below the horizon; n. atmospheric phenomena accompa...
appliance ə'plaɪns POS: n	n. 器械, 用具, 应用; [医] 矫正器; 器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a device or control that is very useful for a particular job; n. durable goods for home or office use

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
registrar 'redʒɪstrə: POS: n	n. 记录者, 登记者, 登记官员; [医] 登记员, 挂号员, 专科住院医师 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person employed to keep a record of the owners of stocks and bonds issued by the company; n. the administ...
sunrise 'sʌnraɪz POS: n	n. 日出, 黎明, 拂晓 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. atmospheric phenomena accompanying the daily appearance of the sun; n. the daily event of the sun rising ab...
barber 'bɑ:bə POS: n	n. 理发师 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. United States composer (1910–1981); n. a hairdresser who cuts hair and shaves beards as a trade; v. perform...
vocation vəʊ'keɪʃən POS: n	n. 职业, 天命, 天职, 才能, 行业; [法] 行业, 职业, 职业上的才能 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the particular occupation for which you are trained; n a body of people doing the same kind of work
cashier kæ'ʃɪə POS: n	n. 出纳员; [经] 司库, 出纳员, 收支员 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person responsible for receiving payments for goods and services (as in a shop or restaurant); v. discard...